包饺子

一个外国学生第一次包饺子

Making Dumplings

A foreign student makes dumplings for the first time

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Footnotes mark names and words above HSK 2 (HSK 3.0 lists: github.com/ivankra/hsk30, MIT).

1 汤姆[†]是一个外国留学生，在中国学习汉语。高天[‡]是他的同学，也是他的好朋友。快过年了，高天说："汤姆，过年的时候你来我家吧！我们一起包饺子。"汤姆很高兴，可是他没包过饺子，也没看见过别人包。

去朋友家

2 过年那天下午，汤姆来到高天家。高天的爸爸、妈妈和妹妹都在家。汤姆说："您好！新年好！"高天的妈妈笑着说："欢迎欢迎！快进来，外边太冷了。"

3 桌子上放着很多东西：一大碗肉和菜，还有很多白色的、小小的东西，一个一个放在那儿。汤姆问："这些是什么？"高天的妹妹说："这是饺子的衣服！"大家都笑了。

† 汤姆 *Tāngmǔ* Tom, a foreign student

‡ 高天 *Gāo Tiān* Gao Tian, Tom's classmate

Tom is a foreign student learning Chinese in China. Gao Tian is his classmate and also his good friend. The New Year was coming, and Gao Tian said, "Tom, come to my place for the New Year! We'll make dumplings together." Tom was delighted, but he had never made dumplings, or even seen anyone else make them. 1

Visiting a Friend

On the afternoon of New Year's Eve, Tom arrived at Gao Tian's home. Gao Tian's father, mother and little sister were all at home. "Hello!" said Tom. "Happy New Year!" Gao Tian's mother smiled. "Welcome, welcome! Come in quickly, it's too cold outside." 2

The table was covered with things: a big bowl of meat and vegetables, and lots of little white things laid out one by one. "What are these?" asked Tom. Gao Tian's little sister said, "These are the dumplings' coats!" Everyone laughed. 3

3 高天[†]说：“我妹妹说得对。我们先做好饺子的‘衣服’，然后在‘衣服’里放肉和菜。”

饺子的衣服

4 高天的妈妈教汤姆[‡]包饺子。她一边包，一边说：“你看着我的手。先拿一个‘衣服’，放在左手上。然后用筷子在中间放一点儿肉和菜，不要放太多。最后用两只手关上它，一个饺子就包好了。”她包得很快，一个又一个，都很漂亮。

5 汤姆听懂了，也看懂了，可是自己包的时候就不一样了。他的第一个饺子放了太多肉，还没包好，肉和菜就跑出来了。第二个饺子很小，像一只小鸟。第三个饺子很长，像一只小船。高天的妹妹看着汤姆的饺子，笑得说不出话来。

6 汤姆有点儿不好意思。

† 高天 *Gāo Tiān* Gao Tian, Tom's classmate ‡ 汤姆 *Tāngmǔ* Tom, a foreign student

"My sister's right," said Gao Tian. "First we make the dumplings' 'coats', and then we put the meat and vegetables inside them." 3

The Dumplings' Coats

Gao Tian's mother taught Tom how to make dumplings. As she worked, she said, "Watch my hands. First take one 'coat' and put it on your left hand. Then use your chopsticks to put a little meat and vegetables in the middle. Don't put in too much. Finally, close it up with both hands, and there's your dumpling." She worked very fast, one after another, and every one was beautiful. 4

Tom understood what she said and what she did, but doing it himself was another matter. His first dumpling had too much meat in it, and before he had even closed it, the filling ran out. His second dumpling was tiny, like a little bird. His third was long, like a little boat. Gao Tian's little sister looked at Tom's dumplings and laughed so hard she couldn't speak. 5

Tom felt a little embarrassed. 6

6 高天†说：“没关系！我第一次包饺子的时候，包得比你还难看。”高天的爸爸坐到汤姆‡旁边，拿着他的手教他：“别急。先放少一点儿肉，然后慢一点儿关上。”汤姆又包了一个。这次，肉和菜没有跑出来！

7 包了一个小时，汤姆的饺子越来越好看了。大家一边包饺子，一边说话。高天的爸爸告诉汤姆，过年的时候，很多北方人家里都吃饺子。有人说，饺子的样子像很久以前的钱，所以过年吃饺子，明年会有钱。

8 这时候，高天的妈妈拿出一块钱，洗得干干净净，放在一个饺子里。她说：“吃到这个饺子的人，明年什么事都会很顺利。”汤姆没看到她放在哪个饺子里了。

† 高天 *Gāo Tiān* Gao Tian, Tom's classmate ‡ 汤姆 *Tāngmǔ* Tom, a foreign student

"Don't worry!" said Gao Tian. "The first time I made dumplings, mine looked even worse than yours." Gao Tian's father sat down next to Tom, took his hands and showed him. "Don't rush. First put in a bit less meat, then close it up a bit more slowly." Tom made another one. This time the filling didn't escape! 6

After an hour, Tom's dumplings were looking better and better. Everyone chatted as they worked. Gao Tian's father told Tom that at New Year, lots of families in the north eat dumplings. Some say dumplings look like money from long ago, so if you eat dumplings at New Year, you'll have money in the year ahead. 7

Just then, Gao Tian's mother took out a one-yuan coin, washed it until it was spotless, and put it inside a dumpling. She said, "Whoever gets this dumpling will find that everything goes smoothly next year." Tom didn't see which dumpling she put it in. 8

有钱的饺子

9 饺子都包完了，一共一百多个。水开了以后，妈妈一个一个放进了饺子。十几分钟以后，饺子好了。大家坐在桌子旁边吃饺子。

10 汤姆†找到了自己包的“小鸟”和“小船”。它们不好看，可是味道很好。他一边吃，一边说：“太好吃了！”忽然，他吃到了一个东西，不是肉，也不是菜。他拿出来一看，是一块钱！

11 大家都笑着说：“汤姆吃到了！汤姆明年会很顺利！”高天‡的妹妹看了看那个饺子，说：“妈妈，这个饺子像一只小船，是汤姆自己包的！”妈妈笑了：“对，钱是我放在他的饺子里的。汤姆第一次在我们家过年，这块钱应该是他的。”

12 汤姆听了，非常感动。

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The Lucky Dumpling

All the dumplings were made: more than a hundred altogether. When the water was boiling, Mum put the dumplings in one by one. Ten-odd minutes later, the dumplings were ready. Everyone sat round the table and ate. 9

Tom found his own "little birds" and "little boats". They didn't look nice, but they tasted good. He kept saying as he ate, "These are delicious!" Suddenly he bit on something that wasn't meat and wasn't vegetables. He took it out to look: it was a one-yuan coin! 10

Everyone laughed and said, "Tom got it! Tom's going to have a great year!" Gao Tian's little sister looked at the dumpling and said, "Mum, this dumpling looks like a little boat. Tom made it himself!" Mum smiled. "Yes, I put the coin in one of his. It's Tom's first New Year with us, so the coin should be his." 11

Tom was deeply touched. 12

他拿着那块钱，说：“谢谢你们！明年过年，我还要来包饺子。那时候，我的饺子一定不像小船了！”

Holding the coin, he said, "Thank you all! Next New Year I'm coming to make 12
dumplings again. And by then, my dumplings definitely won't look like little boats!"